

Ukraine's human capital landscape shows cautious optimism: diaspora return programs are gaining traction, domestic graduates are choosing to stay, and HR excellence is being institutionalized. However, the \$15B+ reconstruction financing gap and ongoing brain drain to UK and US remain critical headwinds requiring coordinated policy response.

Kyiv-Mohyla's 1,275 graduates who chose Ukraine signal a retain-side success, but must be matched with economic opportunity from reconstruction investment to prevent delayed emigration.

RETURN

CREATE UKRAINE: Diaspora Return Program for Young Professionals

CREATE UKRAINE targets young Ukrainian professionals abroad, offering structured pathways to return and contribute to reconstruction. The Kyiv Post-promoted initiative frames return as a career opportunity, linking diaspora talent directly to Ukraine's rebuilding agenda.

3R: Direct Return lever: structured diaspora reactivation program with career framing reduces psychological barrier to return for war-displaced professionals.

KYIV POST / FACEBOOK

World Bank PAD: \$15B+ Reconstruction Gap as Return Enabler

The World Bank's Project Appraisal Document identifies a \$15B+ financing gap for Ukraine's 2026 recovery priorities. Closing this gap through structured investment creates jobs and stability essential to incentivize diaspora return at scale.

3R: Return prerequisite: without reconstruction investment materializing into jobs, diaspora return programs lack economic pull-factor to sustain repatriation.

WORLD BANK

RECRUIT

OECD: AI as Tool to Fill Skill Gaps in Ageing Societies

OECD early insights show AI can alleviate acute labour and skill shortages in ageing societies. Ukraine, facing demographic decline and wartime displacement, can leverage AI-augmented workflows to compensate for missing talent pools in critical reconstruction sectors.

3R: Recruit alternative: AI adoption reduces dependency on scarce human capital, buying time for diaspora return and workforce reconstruction programs.

OECD

Ukraine HR Awards 2026: Recognizing Effective Talent Practices

Ukrainian employers can submit nominations until August 14, 2026 for Ukraine's premier HR awards recognizing effective talent management, skills development, and workplace practices. This signals institutionalization of employer competition for scarce domestic talent.

3R: Recruit enabler: awards incentivize employer investment in talent attraction and development practices critical to filling domestic skill gaps.

UA.NEWS

Kyiv Security Expo 2026: Defence Sector Talent Demand Signal

The 5th International Security Exhibition hosted in Kyiv (May 2026) highlights surging demand for security, defence technology, and cyber professionals. This sector represents a high-priority recruit target where Ukraine faces acute skill shortages and international competition for talent.

3R: Recruit signal: defence-tech sector growth creates urgent skill demand that neither diaspora return nor domestic training can fill quickly enough without targeted recruitment.

EXPERT SECURITY UKRAINE

RETAIN

Convocation 2026: Kyiv-Mohyla Graduates Choose Ukraine

Kyiv-Mohyla Academy graduated 1,275 professionals in 2026 — 769 bachelors, 506 masters — with reporting emphasis on graduates choosing to remain in Ukraine. This cohort represents a critical retain success story amid wartime emigration pressures.

3R: Retain success signal: graduate retention indicates institutional and patriotic pull factors are functioning; must be matched with job market absorption capacity.

HROMADA.US

London as 'Kyiv-on-Thames': 286,000+ Ukrainian Visa Holders in UK

Since March 2022, the UK granted 286,000+ visas to Ukrainians, with London emerging as the hub for young Ukrainian entrepreneurs. This entrenched diaspora community represents both a brain drain risk and a potential return/recruit asset if properly engaged.

3R: Retain risk: entrenched UK settlement with entrepreneurial network formation reduces return probability; requires targeted engagement before social roots deepen further.

MACE MAGAZINE

GLOBAL CONTEXT

North Macedonia Brain Drain Model: Lessons for Ukraine Diaspora Engagement

Migration Policy Institute analysis of North Macedonia's brain drain and circular migration strategies offers comparative lessons. War in Ukraine intensified Ukrainian flows to the US, mirroring Balkan emigration patterns. North Macedonia's diaspora engagement frameworks provide transferable policy models.

3R: Global context: Balkan circular migration models offer Ukraine tested policy frameworks for diaspora reactivation without demanding permanent return.

MIGRATION POLICY INSTITUTE

Albania-Ukraine Solidarity: Geopolitical Support Stabilizes Human Capital Environment

Albanian President Begaj's Kyiv visit reaffirmed unwavering support for Ukraine, honoring soldiers, civilians, medical workers, and teachers. Sustained international solidarity signals security credibility that underpins decisions by diaspora and professionals to return or stay.

3R: Enabling context: visible allied solidarity reduces perceived security risk, a key psychological barrier blocking diaspora return and professional retention decisions.

RTSH ALBANIA

IOM Administrative Coordination: Return-to-Work Process Facilitation

IOM's vacancy for Senior Administrative Assistants includes facilitating coordinated return-to-work and workplace accommodation processes. This operational capacity-building within IOM signals growing institutional infrastructure supporting displaced worker reintegration pathways.

3R: Systemic enabler: IOM operational capacity expansion supports reintegration infrastructure critical for both returning diaspora and internally displaced workers.

IOM
